Jews who disavow Jewishness (whether national, or ethnic, or religious) are "universal" Jews, according to Badiou, and in this camp he places Spinoza, Marx, and Freud. In the other camp he puts the entire state of Israel, which becomes, in the title of the first chapter of "Uses of the Word 'Jew,'" "the country in the world where there are the fewest Jews."

Badiou had already developed what I see as the essence of this thinking on the Jews and universalism in his 1997 book *Saint Paul: The Foundation of Universalism*, which unlike the books on antisemitism is widely discussed in academic circles.[15] Badiou makes it clear from the start of this book that his motivation in turning to ancient Christianity lies not in the properly Christian religious dimension of Paul's teaching, which Badiou dismisses as a mere fable, but rather in the resonance of what Paul had to say about the Jews and universalism for contemporary France. He locates the essence of Paul's teaching in his famous statement of religious universalism, "There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus" (Gal. 3:28). Indeed, Badiou's entire book can be understood as a gloss on this statement, which he interprets as announcing the existence of a new kind of subject, a subject "devoid of all identity" except that made possible through a single "event" that cannot be proven (the resurrection of Christ). According to Badiou, just as Paul replaces the concreteness of Jewish law, engraved in stone and manifest in physical signs (circumcision), with the abstractness of Christian law based on faith alone, so too does he create a subject who transcends the tribal, ethnic, national identity of the Jews, or any kind of terrestrial determination whatsover, including class and gender. Badiou explains that this is the basis of universalism both in Paul's time and in our own. "What is essential for us is that this paradoxical connection between a subject without identity and a law without support provides the foundation for the possibility of a universal teaching within history itself."[16] Whereas the Jews had tied truth to the law, which Badiou claims was only ever particular or applicable to the Jews alone, Paul makes truth available to all believers. "Paul's unprecedented gesture consists in subtracting truth from the communitarian grasp, be it that of a people, a city, an empire, a territory, or a social class" (p. 5). Paul, in other words, frees truth from the communitarianism of the Jews. But whereas for Paul, this meant freedom from Jewish law, for the radical French philosopher, freedom means overcoming nationalism, capitalism, and identity politics—for Badiou, all still associated with the Jews).[17]

One of the many outrageous features of Badiou's analysis is that he presents himself as a philosemite. In "Uses of the Word 'Jew,'" he says he wants to protect the "Jews" from themselves: "A 'goy' [non-Jew] says it pas-

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